RAVI LIYANARACHCHI

Executive Director - Operations - Garment Manufacturing, Merchandising & Business Growth

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EXECUTIVE PROFILE

COO-level garment manufacturing and merchandising leader with 25+ years of international experience across Sri Lanka, Bangladesh and Vietnam. Proven record in building and scaling woven garment operations, Lean production systems, industrial engineering, buyer development, supply chain management, merchandising coordination and factory profitability. Experienced in leading multi-site operations, managing large production teams, improving production efficiency, reducing cost per minute losses, strengthening on-time delivery performance and supporting strategic growth for global brands. Combines deep technical manufacturing expertise with sales, marketing and buyer-facing commercial knowledge to improve profit margins and long-term business performance.

COO VALUE PROPOSITION

- Executive leadership across manufacturing, merchandising, supply chain, industrial engineering, quality, sales and marketing.
- Experience managing large-scale operations including 60 production lines and 2,400 sewing operators, with exposure to operations valued at 100 million turnover.
- Established Lean production facilities and new woven shirt/pants production setups for major international buyers.
- Increased production efficiency from 65% to 75% while sustaining strong on-time delivery performance.
- Improved profit margins through Lean implementation, technical process control, CM loss reduction, better manpower utilisation, strategic sourcing and marketing-led buyer development.
- Maintained A-grade supplier status with international customers by aligning quality, delivery, compliance and cost performance.

P&L, PROFITABILITY & BUSINESS PERFORMANCE LEADERSHIP

P&L (Profit and Loss) responsibility means taking ownership of the company's revenue, cost structure and final profitability. In a garment manufacturing business, this includes monitoring sales revenue, CM/FOB profitability, labour cost, material utilisation, overheads, production efficiency, rework, shipment performance, inventory, wastage, buyer pricing and operational losses. My approach is to connect the commercial side of the business with technical manufacturing control, so every department contributes to stronger margins.

Margin improvement approach: I improved company profitability by using my technical background in Industrial Engineering, Lean Manufacturing, GSD/PMTS costing, capacity planning and production flow optimisation, together with marketing and buyer-development knowledge. This allowed me to identify loss-making processes, reduce non-value-added activities, control cost per minute losses, improve line balancing, reduce lost time, increase production efficiency and support better order selection, pricing and buyer communication. In my recent roles, these initiatives contributed to a 10% profit margin improvement, a 10% production efficiency enhancement and a 5% cost reduction through process optimisation and strategic sourcing.

SELECTED EXECUTIVE ACHIEVEMENTS

Area	Result / Business Impact
Profitability & P&L	Increased profit margins by 10% through Lean operations, CM loss control, cost reduction, productivity improvement and better

	commercial alignment.
Operational Efficiency	Raised production efficiency from 65% to 75% while maintaining strong delivery and quality standards.
Delivery Performance	Achieved 99% on-time delivery across major clients and maintained disciplined shipment execution.
Lean Transformation	Established fully Lean manufacturing plants and implemented waste-reduction systems across large-scale garment operations.
Manufacturing Scale	Led 60 production lines with 2,400 sewing operators and managed end-to-end operations including supply chain, merchandising, washing, printing, embroidery and packing.
Buyer & Brand Management	Worked with international brands including Levi's, VF, Lee, Wrangler, Target Australia, Columbia, M&S, IZOD, CK, Tommy, Van Heusen and LPP.
Technical Innovation	Introduced Japanese woven manufacturing standards, IE tools, ERP/planning systems, GSD/PMTS costing and modern automation methods.

CORE COMPETENCIES

COO Leadership	**P&L & Margin Improvement**	**Garment Manufacturing Strategy**
Merchandising & Buyer Relations	**Lean Manufacturing / Six Sigma**	**Industrial Engineering & GSD/PMTS**
Factory Turnaround & Scaling	**Supply Chain & Vendor Management**	**Quality, Compliance & ESG**
Capacity Planning & Costing	**Sales & Marketing Strategy**	**ERP, Automation & Digital Tools**
Woven Shirts, Pants & Denim	**Team Development & Training**	**International Market Expansion**

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Operations Manager - Manufacturing | *King Koil USA / Suyamas International Pvt Ltd, Colombo, Sri Lanka* **| 2025 - Present**

- Promoted after rejoining the company to lead manufacturing innovation while aligning marketing, logistics, industrial engineering and operational performance.
- Oversee showroom operations, sales growth, customer service, inventory management, vendor coordination, staff training and day-to-day operational controls.
- Drove operational efficiency and business growth, increasing profit margins by 10% through manufacturing process improvements, cost control and stronger market alignment.
- Use technical manufacturing expertise and marketing knowledge to connect product quality, delivery reliability and customer value with improved commercial performance.

Executive Director - Operations | *Explore Garments Pvt Ltd (Hameem Group), Dhaka, Bangladesh* **| 2023 - 2025**

- Led establishment of a new project with 50 Lean production lines, including innovative woven pants and shirt production setups for top international brands.
- Directed production operations, strategic planning, efficiency enhancement, Lean implementation, quality control and production-floor performance.
- Built an innovative woven shirt production floor for high-profile buyers including IZOD, CK, Tommy, Columbia, Van Heusen and LPP.
- Introduced Japanese woven manufacturing standards to improve quality, consistency, productivity and buyer confidence.
- Achieved 10% production efficiency enhancement and 5% cost reduction through process optimisation and strategic sourcing.

Factory Head - Manufacturing | *Suyamas International Pvt Ltd, King Koil USA Licensed Facility, Horana, Sri Lanka* **| 2020 - 2023**

- Led the King Koil mattress manufacturing facility, overseeing quilting, latex, rebonding and packing operations.
- Transferred apparel-sector manufacturing discipline into mattress production during the COVID period, building a skilled multi-functional team.
- Improved workflow, workforce planning, quality control and production stability across a technically different manufacturing environment.

General Manager | *Pearl Global Pvt Ltd / New World Fashion Group - Nam.Co, Hanoi, Vietnam* **| 2018 - 2020**

- Managed overall factory operations including capacity planning, workforce optimisation, process improvement, quality and shipment performance.
- Handled woven clothing products and European buyers including M&S; managed specialised seam-sealing jackets and filling jackets.
- Implemented advanced IE techniques to reduce inefficiencies and improve cost-effectiveness.
- Increased production efficiency from 65% to 75%, achieved 0% lost time from production floor to packaging and maintained 100% on-time deliveries.
- Reduced cost per minute losses, improved margins and maintained A-grade supplier status with international customers.

General Manager - Operations and Technical | *ZXY International, Chittagong, Bangladesh* **| 2016 - 2018**

- Oversaw two manufacturing facilities covering development, sample creation, production operations and supply chain management.
- Implemented manpower utilisation strategies to improve productivity, efficiency and operational discipline.
- Established structured technical training for production teams to strengthen skill levels and execution quality.
- Managed business operations for an organisation with 100 million turnover exposure.

IE Group / Operations Manager / Unit Head | *Ken Park Bangladesh Apparels (Pvt) Ltd, Chittagong, Bangladesh* **| 2001 - 2016**

- Pioneered a fully Lean manufacturing plant supporting global brands including Levi's, VF, Lee, Wrangler, Target Australia and Columbia.
- Led 60 production lines and 2,400 sewing operators across supply chain, merchandising, printing, embroidery, washing and packaging operations.
- Specialised in denim jeans, casual/formal pants, jackets, schoolwear and children's apparel.
- Implemented Lean principles to improve efficiency, reduce waste, control production losses and strengthen profitability.
- Managed business operations for an organisation with 100 million turnover exposure.

IE & Lean Manager | *Hirdaramani Mercury Apparels (Pvt) Ltd, Sri Lanka* **| 1997 - 2001**

- Revitalised the IE department by recruiting and training a new team of Industrial Engineers.
- Managed capacity planning and SMV costing using PMTS and GSD systems.
- Introduced Lean practices to improve factory efficiency, reduce waste and strengthen productivity.

Production Executive | *Hirdaramani Mercury Apparels (Pvt) Ltd, Sri Lanka* **| 1994 - 1996**

- Prepared and executed production schedules and shipment targets.
- Coordinated pre-production meetings and process planning with IE teams.
- Ensured compliance with customer specifications, production standards and product quality requirements.

GARMENT MANUFACTURING & MERCHANDISING EXPOSURE

- Product categories: woven shirts, woven pants, denim jeans, formal/casual pants, jackets, schoolwear, children's apparel, seam-sealing jackets and filling jackets.
- Merchandising exposure: buyer communication, sample development, costing support, capacity planning, order execution, delivery follow-up and cross-functional coordination between production, IE, quality, supply chain and commercial teams.
- Buyer/brand exposure: Levi's, VF, Lee, Wrangler, Target Australia, Columbia, M&S, IZOD, CK, Tommy, Van Heusen and LPP.

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL QUALIFICATIONS

- Degree in Business Management - NIBM, Sri Lanka
- Advanced Diploma in Labour Management - IMS (UK)
- Industrial Engineering, Production Organisation & Quality Control - Textile Department, University of Moratuwa, Sri Lanka
- Production Organisation and Management Program in Japan - AOTS, Toyota and Denso Company
- Diploma in Maintenance & Repairing of Industrial Sewing Machines
- GCE Advanced Level (A/L) Examination
- GCE Ordinary Level (O/L) Examination

AWARD & LEAN CERTIFICATION

- Nike Lean Graduate (Blue Belt) - 2013; progressed through continuous Lean Manufacturing improvement toward Black Belt-level practice.

REFERENCES

- Mr. Ajith De Silva - Former Managing Director, Ken Park Bangladesh (Pvt) Ltd, Karnaphuli E.P.Z, Chittagong, Bangladesh | +880 1713 109000
- Mr. Nimal Perera - VP / Business Head, Epic Group Dhaka | +880 1731 771609

Declaration: I hereby affirm that the information provided above is accurate and true to the best of my knowledge.